The Crown of Idbol Bark

The Crown of Idbol Bark is a *tabletop role-playing* ***adventure*** in which the party attempts to arrest an upstart "king", usually taking two to four hours to complete. This adventure was written to be played with the attached rules, but can be adapted for any system.

This adventure is ready to be used, but isn't finalized. Things might be unfair to players, or unclear to narrators. If you encounter any issues, please send me an email at emsenn@emsenn.net

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Danger is never far in the *Gloaming*, where marshes and mesas give home to bandits and beasts. The lone *trade road* through the region is a gauntlet for traveling merchants. The town of *Belcaer* is a haven for those travelers.

Built by the same group of *magic* users who built the *trade road*, the town was originally a fortress, built on top of a limestone mesa. Now, casinos and hotels fill the fortress walls, taking what coins they can from people before they pass by.

Recently there haven't been many coins to take. A bandit calling himself "King Brag" has been mugging travelers. Now, farmers are reporting missing livestock.

An official of the *Chandlers Guild* named *Abeth Harbrook* believes she has located where the "king" is hiding: *Jacob's Folly*, a limestone tower built and abandoned in the forgotten past.

She's posted a bulletin offering to pay anyone who captures the "king," and the party has come to her office in the town's *Guildhouse*, a large pine timber building.

This adventure is set in tragically funny fantasy world of Teraum, in the year 80pc, during the *Reconstruction Era*. TK

This adventure comes with suggested characters that the players could use as their adventurers. See the "Character Templates" section.

There are other adventures set in Teraum, along with lots of other material! To view the entire library, visit https://emsenn.net/teraum/

Before beginning the session, your party should know:

- How much does each of them weigh, with and without equipment?
- Is anyone a high-ranking officer in the *Chandlers Guild*?



NOTE: Don't read past this point unless you're planning to *narrate* this adventure. If you aren't sure what that means, read the "Abridged Rules" section at the end of this document.

Exposition

Settings

- ***Belcaer:*** A town of about four-hundred residents and two-hundred travelers, located on the trade road between two distant cities. It is built on a short mesa with a single road leading into it, and has recently been experiencing an economic boom. It is located in a region known as...

- ***The Gloaming:*** A vast region of fens and marshes, broken up by mesas and rock outcroppings. The region is sparsely populated and relatively lawless.

- ***Jacob's Folly:*** A four-storey limestone tower built about eight miles west of *Belcaer*. It's unknown when or why it was built - it is far from any road or notable landmark.

Cast

- ***Abeth Harbrook:*** The local ranking member of the *Chandlers Guild*, a large commercial organization with offices in many towns, villages, and cities across the *human* world.

- ***King Bark:*** A *goblin* who lives with his clan in *Jacob's Folly*.

The Plot

Scene One: Receiving the Quest

The party has a meeting with *Abeth Harbrook*, the local representative of the *Chandlers Guild*. Her office is located in the *Guildhouse*, a recently constructed pine timber building at the edge of *Belcaer*.

She will tell the party:

- In the early spring, travelers passing by began to be mugged.

- Later in spring, livestock began to disappear. Mostly horses.

- Early in summer, graffiti reading *King Bark was here* began appearing on barns and silos.

- Rumors are that the bandits responsible are living in *Jacob's Folly*, a tower eight miles west of *Belcaer*.

If the party **risks** questioning her further, Abeth may reveal that victims report the bandits as exceptionally tall individuals in long cloaks and masks. She didn't share this information at first because she doesn't give much credit to the rumors of farmers.

Scene Two: Travel to the Tower

The tower is approximately eight miles away, and given the rocky and marshy terrain, would be hard to get to on horseback. It'll

probably take three to five hours to travel to on foot.

How does the party get to Jacob's Folly?

If traveling at night or in inclement weather, the party **risks** getting lost, though **knowledge** of navigation would help.

If the party travels quietly (such as at night or in inclement weather,) as they approach the tower, they will remain undetected until reaching "Scene Three."

Otherwise, they will be met by a group of "bandits" on the road, who declare, in sqeaky rough voices, that declares they are in the territory of *King Bark*, and must surrender their money and supplies.

Each bandit is actually two *goblins* in a long cloak, one standing on the others shoulders and wearing a mask.

How does the party handle these "bandits"?

They're more inclined to run than fight to the death. If captured, they will happily give the party directions to Jacob's Folly, saying that *King Bark* would be happy for them to come bend the knee.

Scene Three: The Tower Exterior

Because of the limestone outcroppings that break up the *Gloaming*, the tower is not visible until the party has nearly entered the acre-sized field in which it was constructed.

Jacob's Folly is a three-storey limestone tower, approximately twenty-five feet tall and ten feet across. The tower's entrance has been sealed with the same limestone bricks as the tower - but there are a couple of windows near the top, and five pine planks on each shoved into the mortar form a rough ladder up to the windows.

There are *goblins* working around the tower, digging toilets and tearing up grass and stuffing it in sacks. When a member of the party moves into the field, any goblins near them will quietly move toward the tower, informing others on the way.

Some goblins will remain outside the tower, hiding behind rock outcroppings in the field and throwing stones and debris at the party. If the party **risks** engaging with any of those *goblins*, goblins at the top of the tower will have time to start burning straw on the roof the tower, which they will drop on the party when they approach the bottom of the tower.

If approaching in the evening, the party **risks** being noticed by an owlbear mother that nests on the top of the tower, who will swoop down and harass them, making the *goblins* aware of them. The *owlbear mother* will attempt to carry any small (<120lb) adventurer into its nest, where two hungry *owlbear hatchlings* are waiting for them.

How does the party get into Jacob's Folly?

Placing more than 120lb on any single rung of the goblins' improvised ladder is **risk**, with every 20lb making it **riskier**. Depending on the result, a rung could loosen or break. The adventurer might gain a fear of heights, or could fall, and even break a bone.

An adventurer who gets to the roof of *Jacob's Folly* would be able to take those *hatchlings* and raise them, but unless the *mother* is killed, she will follow her hatchlings to the ends of the world and try and get them back.

Scene Four: The Tower Interior

The inside of the tower is dark, stinky, and beginning to fill with acrid smoke.

When the party enters the room at the top of the tower, through the window on the third storey, they'll find an empty room with some sticks, dry piles of dung, buckets, and a large brass dish that's clearly been used for fires, and might still have straw burning in it. The goblins will retreat down underneath the trap door on the ground floor.

There are two other "floors" inside the tower, though they are empty except for more dirty straw and dung. There is a large, heavy wood door in the floor at the ground level.

Once the party has entered the tower, all the goblins are underneath this trap door, and have removed the ladder normally placed under it. To get to the floor below is a seven-foot drop.

Smoke rises through the trapdoor, filling the tower with thicker smoke that makes every risk riskier.

If the party is on the ground floor during the daytime, they will see light entering the room through cracks in the filled-in doorway. A **strong** character might **risk** knocking the mortar down, letting the smoke out of the tower.

Opening the trapdoor exposes the party to further harassment from the goblins, but provides an opportunity for dialog. The goblins will call the party cowards, and say that if they come down there, *King Bark* is going to get them.

How does the party get to **King Bark?**

Scene Five: The Tower Basement

The room is circular, a bit wider in diameter than the tower above, and is full of farm tools and preserved foodstuff and grains.

Among the approximately two-dozen goblins in this room is one wearing a "crown" made of twisted-together silverware: *Idbol Bark*, leader of this group of goblins.

How does the party capture King Bark?

The goblins have no further means of retreat, so will fight until unable. King Bark has no exceptional combat skills, and no goblin is armed with anything more than farm and kitchen tools.

Epilogue

Once *King Bark* and his goblins have been captured, disbanded, or eliminated, the party should return to *Belcaer* and tell *Abeth Harbrook* what happened, and potentially turn over custody of King Bark and other goblins to her custody.

- How will *Abeth Harbrook* react to claims or evidence of *goblins*?
- Who has possession of the *Crown of Idbol Bark*? Each utensil in it was magic in some way, though they're inactive now. To the right person, or in the right future, it might be quite valuable.

Supplements

Character Templates

- A ***high-ranking investigator from the* Chandlers Guild.** Among other qualities, they're **skilled** at negotiation and **knowledgeable** about bureaucracy. They're here because the Guild is upset with *Abeth Harbrook* for not solving the problem already.
  - How do they feel about Ms. Harbrook's performance?
- A ***local rancher***. Among other qualities, they're **skilled** at navigating the region and **knowledgeable** about local flora and fauna. They're here because *King Bark*'s associates stole their favorite horse.
  - What was their horse's name?
- An out-of-work ***academic***. They're here because they've heard of strange happenings in the region, and where there's mystery, there's money! Among other qualities, they're **skilled** at lying and **knowledgeable** about reading and writing.
  - How can they exploit the mystery of *King Brag's* identity?

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adventure A prepared story that a *narrator* can guide the *party* through. See "Abridged Rules".

adventurer A member of the *party*, a character in the *adventure* that is controlled by a player. See "Abridged Rules".

Belcaer A small town in the *Gloaming* region. See the *Belcaer Gazzetteer*.

Chandlers Guild A commercial organization which operates in advertising, apiculture, bookbinding, candlemaking, among other fields. See "Chandlers Guild" in *Human Culture and Physiology*.

Gloaming A region to the southeast of the *Green Delta* and west of the *Unseen Sea*. Sparsely populated, the region is covered in fens broken by rocky outcroppings. See *Geography and Settlements of the Gloaming*.

goblins Goblins are a race of humanoids that are beginning to reappear along the outskirts of populated areas, after vanishing 80 years ago during the *Collapse*. See "Goblins" in *Magic Creatures of Teraum*.

Green Delta A densely-populated region to the northeast of the *Gloaming*. See *Geography and Settlements of the Green Delta*.

Guildhouse One of the largest buildings in *Belcaer*, home to the offices of the *Chandlers Guild*, among others. See "The Guildhouse" in *Belcaer Gazetteer*.

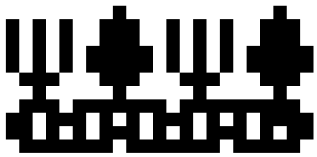
Harbook, Abeth The primary representative of the *Chandlers Guild* in the town of *Belcaer*, with an office in the *Guildhouse*. See "Abeth Harbrook" in the *Belcaer Gazetteer*.

Jacob's Folly A limestone tower built long in the past, well outside the town of *Belcaer*. See "Jacob's Folly" in *Geography and Settlements of the Gloaming*.

narrator The player responsible for starting and guiding an *adventure*. See "Abridged Rules".

party The group of *adventurers* going through a story. See "Abridged Rules".

Unseen Sea A vast desert of unknown size extending southwest from the *Gloaming*. See *Geography and Settlements of the Unseen Sea*.



Rules

Brave Old World is a set of rules for telling a ***story*** by having a structured conversation. It requires a six-sided dice (two is easier), a sheet of paper, something to write with, and two to six players (four to six is better).

One player takes the role of ***narrator***, who starts and guides the story, and the others take the roles of ***adventurers***, characters in that story. The story and characters may be created by the players as a group, or sourced from pre-written ***Adventures***.

The *narrator* says where the adventurers are and what is happening around them. The adventurers say what it is they'd like to do. When an adventurer takes a ***risk***, they roll two six-sided die (or one dice twice) and add the results.

- If they **roll** a 10 or more (**10+**), they **succeed** at what they attempted.
- If they **roll** a 7 through 9 (**7-9**), they **partially succeed**, accomplishing what they attempted but with a cost or consequence.
- If they **roll** a 6 or less (**6-**), they **fail**, and something is going to happen.

If the adventurer is ***knowledgeable*** about or ***skilled*** at what triggered the *roll*, they can add 1 (+1) to their ***result***.

After an player *rolls*, the *narrator* says how the game world reacts to their *result*, and the conversation continues, with players then saying how their adventurer would respond to those reactions.

This continues until players run out of time or reach a good stopping point in the *story*.